

your cardio. The excited part of you wants the results now, but the wise part of you knows you need to get the foundations sorted first.

Laying your financial foundations: The first 5 bricks

Before we begin investing, there are five personal finance concepts to tackle (the bricks in your foundation — see [figure 3.1](#)) so that you begin on the right foot. It's an important part of your overall financial wellness and you'll be thankful that you had this part sorted out before you bought your very first stock or fund. So, to lay your financial foundations, you should:

1. know what's coming in and going out
2. tackle high-interest debt
3. automate your money
4. make a rainy day fund
5. sort out your retirement account.